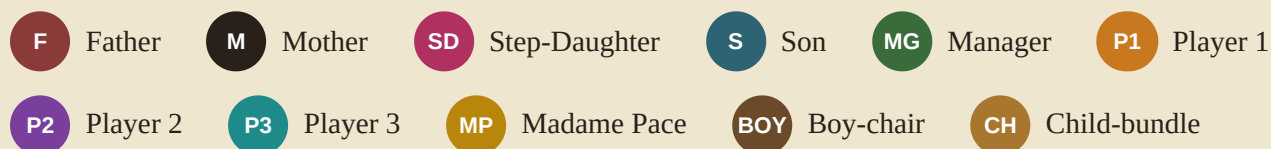


Blocking Storyboard

Every move in the show — the picture and the line it lands on. Six Characters in Search of an Author · Village Players, Lausanne · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi

HOW TO USE IT

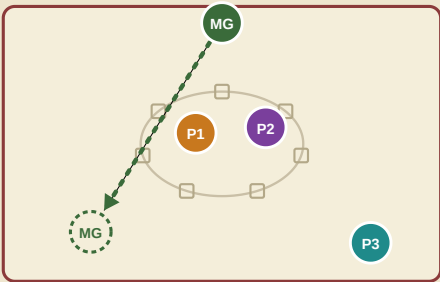
- **One card = one move.** Read the cards top to bottom, in order, act by act and part by part.
- **The picture is the stage from above** — the audience sits at the bottom edge (↓). Everyone on stage in that moment is placed. The move is drawn from a **solid dot** (where the character starts), along a **dashed arrow**, to a **hollow ring** (where they end). A burst marks a sudden event (a gunshot, the revolver, the veil).
- **The text beside it is the line from the script where the move happens** — the spoken line and its stage direction, nothing added. If a card has no arrow, the positions are what matter.
- **Dots are the people; squares are the two stage objects** (□ the Boy-chair, ◇ the Child-bundle). The set is drawn per act: the chair-circle (One), the two-level platform with shower and piano (Two), the fountain (Three).



Act One — The Family

PART I — THE REHEARSAL

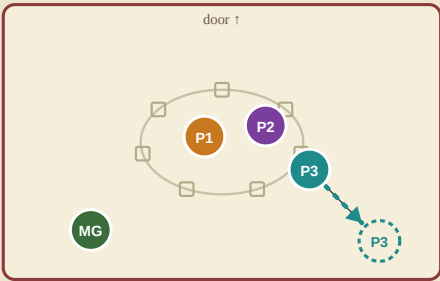
1



audience ↓

THE MANAGER *[entering with the weariness of a man who has run the company too long; he goes to his own chair, set apart]*. I can't see a thing in here. *[to the Property Man]* A little light, please.

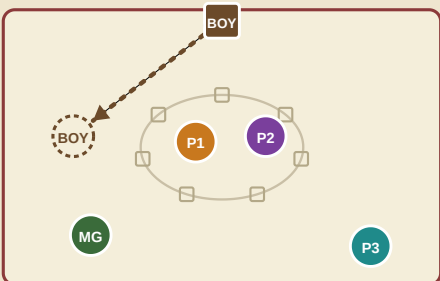
2



audience ↓

PLAYER 1 *[as Leading Man]*. Excuse me, but must I absolutely wear a cook's cap? **PLAYER 3** *[as Prompter, getting into the box]*. Pardon, sir — may I get into my box?

3

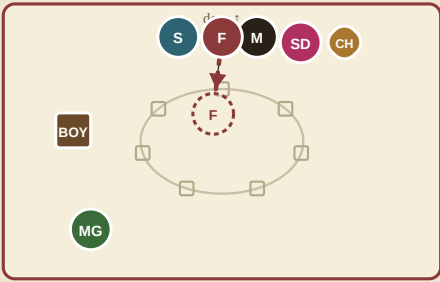


audience ↓

[The white working lights soften to amber. The Door-keeper carries on the Boy-chair and sets it at the edge of the stage; the four live Characters — Father, Mother, Step-Daughter, Son — enter and stop by the door at back, the Step-Daughter carrying the Child-bundle].

PART II — THE INTERRUPTION

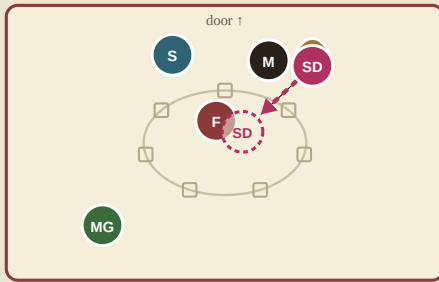
1



audience ↓

THE FATHER *[coming forward, the others following, embarrassed]*. No, for Heaven's sake, what are you saying? We bring you a drama, sir.

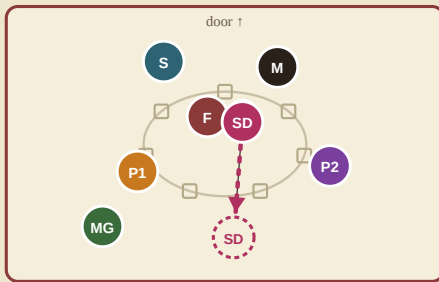
2



audience ↓

THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[crossing behind the Father; a hand on his shoulder, left one beat too long, then withdrawn].* My passion, sir. Ah, if you only knew — my passion for *him*.

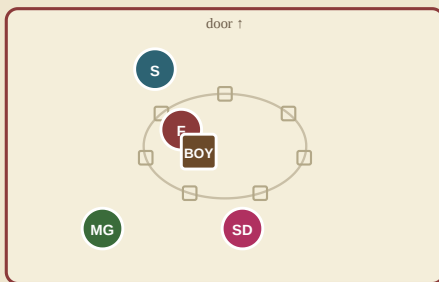
3



audience ↓

THE STEP-DAUGHTER. I, who am a two months' orphan, will show you how well I can dance and sing. *[Sings and dances Prenez garde à Tchou-Tchin-Tchou].*

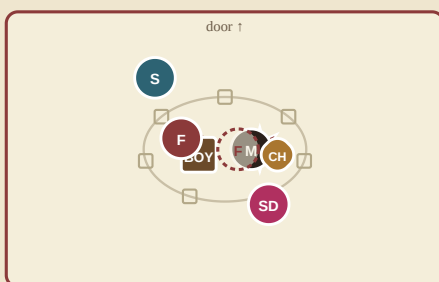
4



audience ↓

THE MOTHER *[one arm tightening round the Child-bundle, the other reaching for the Boy-chair, as if to hold both upright].* In the name of these two little children, I beg you... *[she grows faint]* Oh God!

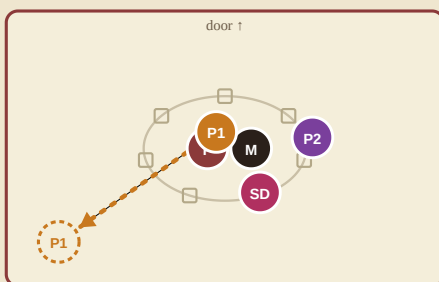
5



audience ↓

THE FATHER *[raising her veil].* Let them see you!

6

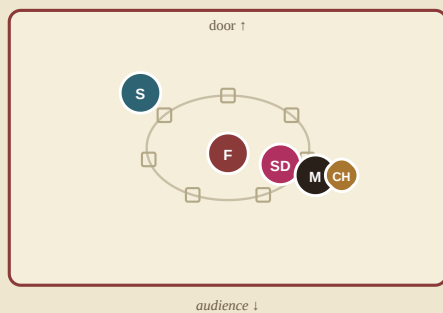


audience ↓

PLAYER 1 *[as Leading Man, beginning to relish it — then his eyes reach the Mother, and the rest does not arrive; the company drifts to the wings to watch].* What a spectacle. What an absolute...

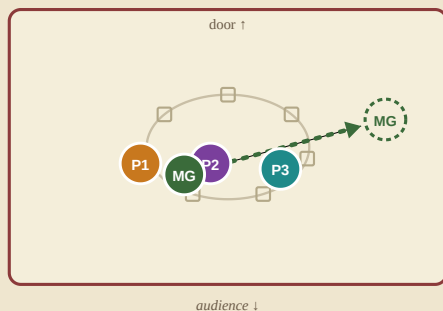
PART III — THE BARGAIN

1



THE STEP-DAUGHTER. The room — I see it. The window with the mantles, the divan, the looking-glass, a screen, and the little mahogany table with the blue envelope and its hundred francs.

2

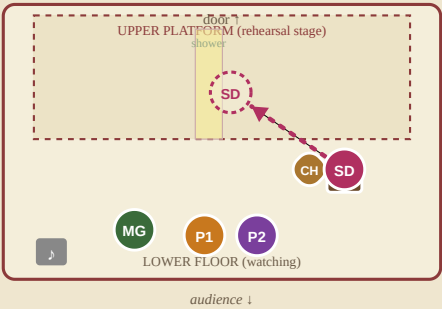


THE MANAGER *[hooked, leading the Father and the Six off to his office to concert the scene].* Come with me to my office. In a quarter of an hour, all back here again. *[Manager and the Six cross the stage and go off; the light has drifted to deep red].*

Act Two — The Theatre

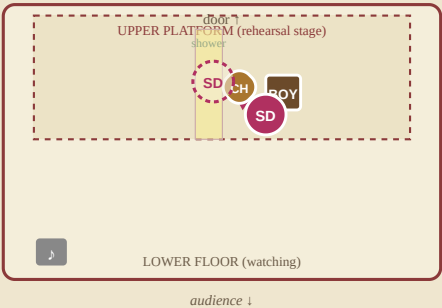
PART I — THE SETUP

1



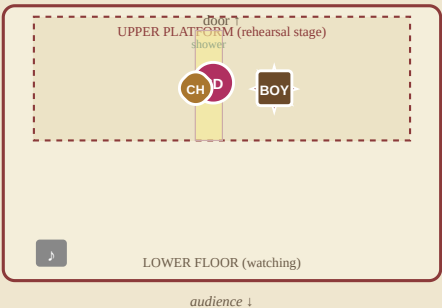
THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[comes out of the office carrying the Child-bundle and dragging the Boy-chair, and goes quickly up onto the platform]. Come on, Rosetta, let's run!*

2



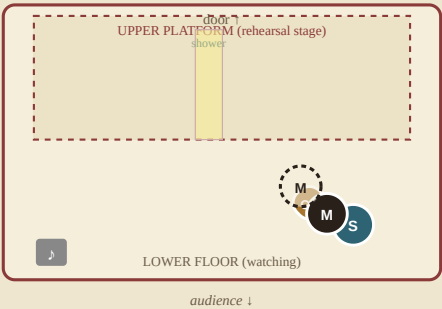
[She drags the Boy-chair a little behind her and leaves it leaning; the stage darkens; the shower — a tight column of light — falls on her alone].

3



THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[bending over the Child-bundle, then turning to the coat on the Boy-chair; she takes the revolver from its pocket].*

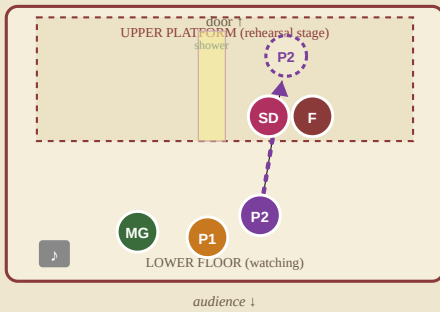
4



THE MOTHER *[rises; one step toward the Son]. My son — [the Son turns away before the word is finished; she stops, and the unfinished word stays in the air].*

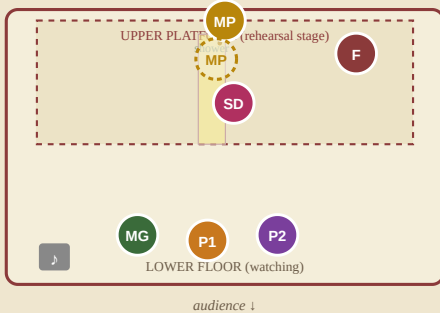
PART II — THE APPARITION

1



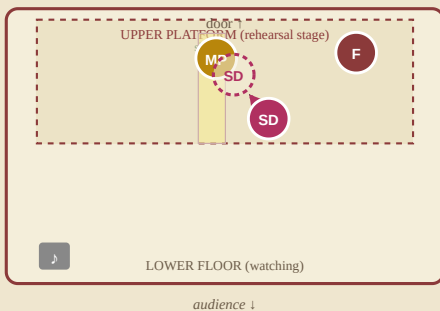
THE FATHER. Would the ladies mind hanging their hats and mantles on the pegs at the back? *[the actresses climb to the platform; the shop window and the screen are set].*

2



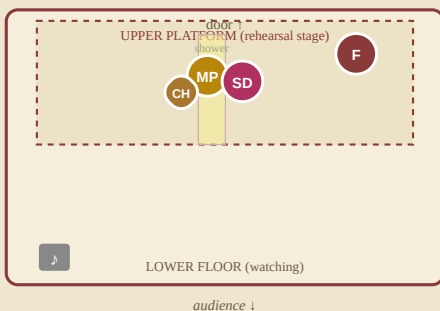
[The door at the back of stage opens and Madame Pace enters and takes a few steps forward — fat, bleach-blonde, the silver chain at her waist].

3



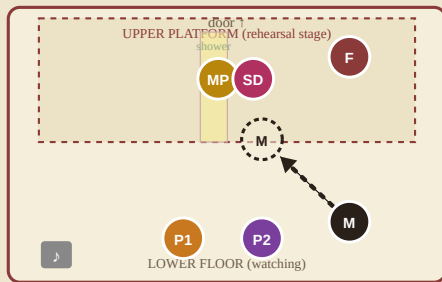
THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[running over to her].* There she is! There she is!

4



[Madame Pace places one hand under the Step-Daughter's chin to raise her head]. **MADAME PACE.** Good morning, good morning, sir! Madame Pace, sir — dresses and coats, off the rue de Bourg.

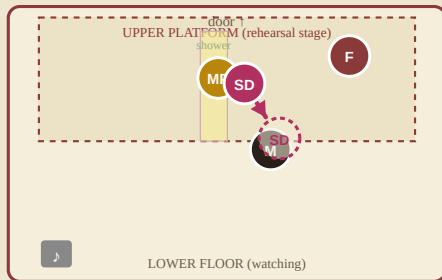
5



audience ↓

THE MOTHER [*jumping up amid the consternation of the actors — the voice she has not used for years*]. You old devil! You murderess!

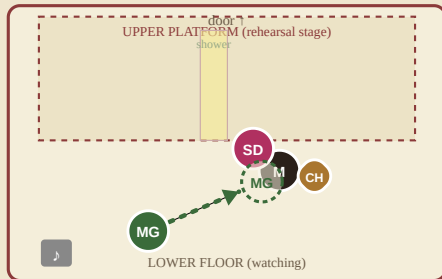
6



audience ↓

THE STEP-DAUGHTER [*running over to calm her Mother*]. Calm yourself, Mother, calm yourself! Please don't...

7

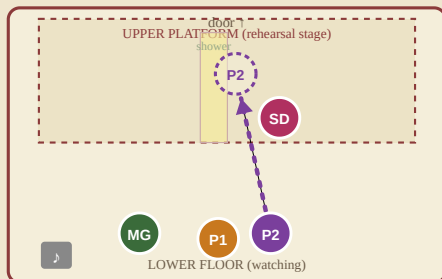


audience ↓

THE MANAGER [*leading her to her chair*]. Come along, my dear lady, sit down now, and let's get on with the scene.

PART III — THE SUBSTITUTION

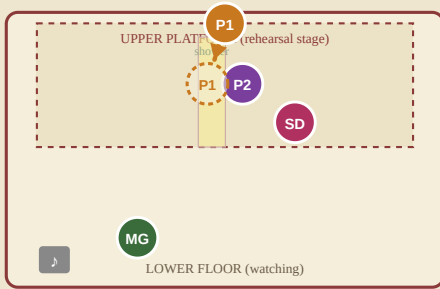
1



audience ↓

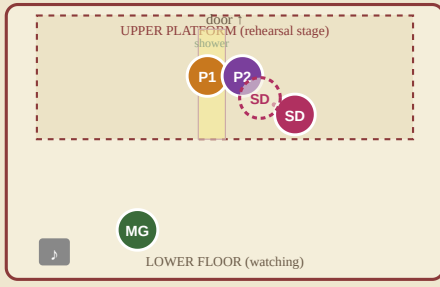
PLAYER 2 [*as Leading Lady; goes to the hat-rack, puts her hat on, and takes the platform to play the Step-Daughter*]. One minute. I want to put my hat on again.

2



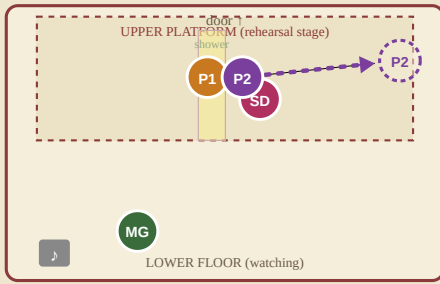
[The door at rear opens and the Leading Man enters with the lively manner of an old gallant]. **PLAYER 1** [as Leading Man]. Good afternoon, Miss.

3



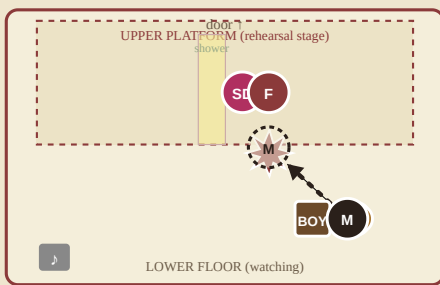
THE STEP-DAUGHTER [bursting out laughing, then advancing toward the actors]. He didn't say "I'm frightfully sorry." He said "Oh."

4



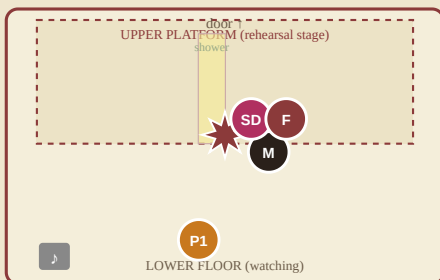
PLAYER 2 [the diva's posture going from offended to leaving]. I am not going to stand here being made a fool of by that woman.

5



THE STEP-DAUGHTER. Cry out, mother. Cry out as you did then!
THE MOTHER [coming forward to separate them; the shower falls on her]. No! My daughter, my daughter! You brute!

6

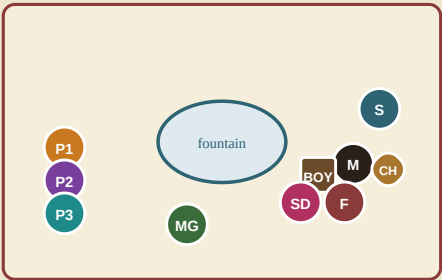


THE MOTHER. It's taking place now. It happens all the time. [the piano cuts out; the Machinist drops the curtain by accident — the act ends on the curtain's fall].

Act Three — The Question

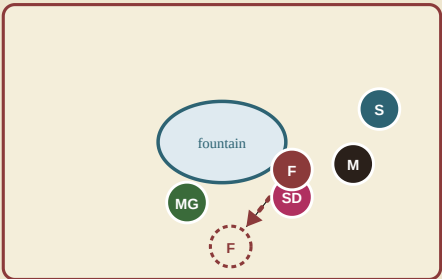
PART I — THE TRAP

1



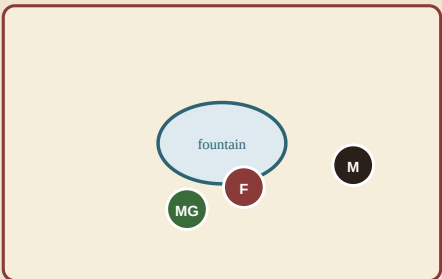
[Curtain up on the bare stage and the fountain. The family sit stage-right, the company stage-left; the Manager stands centre, hand over his mouth, meditating]. **THE MANAGER**. Ah yes: the second act!

2



THE FATHER [turning out toward the house; a pause long enough to feel]. Can you tell me who you are?

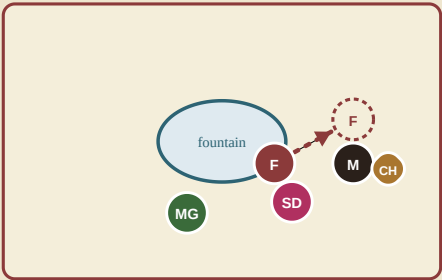
3



THE STEP-DAUGHTER [level, never raised — colder than the philosophy]. His reality. He always knew exactly where to find me.

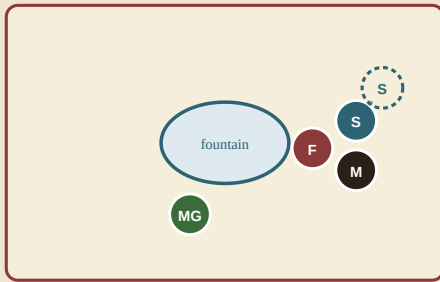
PART II — THE REFUSAL

1



THE FATHER [seizing the Son, not leaving hold]. You've got to obey, do you hear?

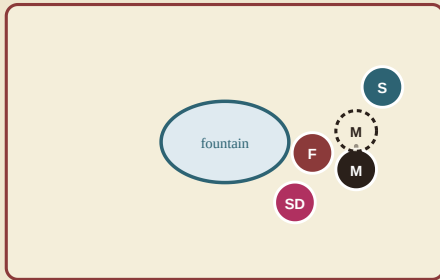
2



audience ↓

THE SON *[the voice cracking, the body refusing the cry; they separate].* What does it mean — this madness you've got? I won't do it. I won't.

3

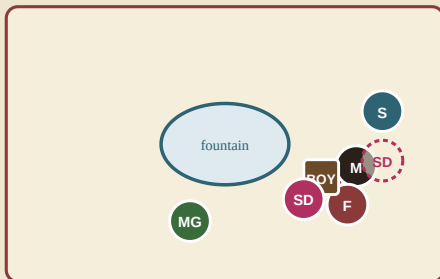


audience ↓

THE MOTHER *[gets up, alarmed and terrified that he is really about to go, and instinctively lifts her arms]. [She does not reach him].*

PART III — THE FOUNTAIN

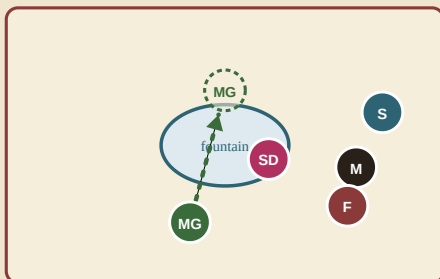
1



audience ↓

THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[lifts the Child-bundle from the Mother's lap and carries it toward the fountain].*

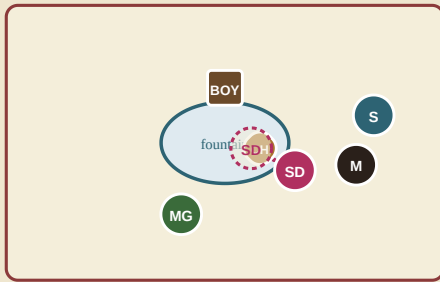
2



audience ↓

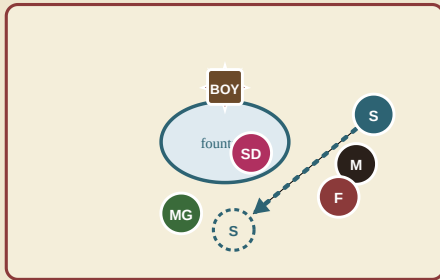
THE MANAGER *[he stands; he picks up the Boy-chair himself and walks it across the stage, and places it behind the fountain basin].*

3



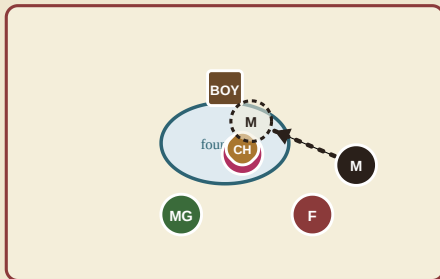
[The Step-Daughter bends over the basin and lowers the Child-bundle into it; the basin's walls hide the action from view].

4



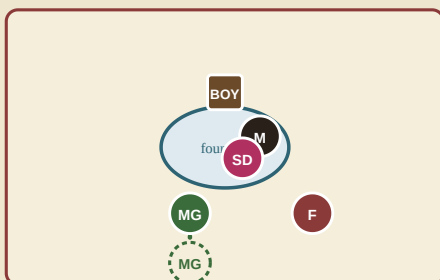
THE SON *[his one continuous sentence; then full blackout]. There in the fountain... [a revolver shot rings out from behind the basin where the Boy-chair is].*

5



THE MOTHER *[she does not cry out at once — she reaches first for the Child-bundle in the basin, then the Boy-chair behind it; her arms cannot hold both, the veil still down]. My son! My son!*

6



THE MANAGER *[a look at the empty Boy-chair, then he turns and leaves the stage the way a man leaves a theatre]. Pretence? Reality? ... To hell with it all.*